1 Future memory practices

A relational approach to social inclusion in digitalised media ecologies

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1 Introduction: situations, contexts, and temporalities of memory work

As divergent forces pulling apart across European societies and the global North and South increase the urgency of bolstering social and cultural inclusion, collective memory making becomes one of the crucial challenges for contemporary societies. Centrifugal cultural forces bring with them both challenges and potentials for establishing inclusive memory politics and for developing heritage as an imaginative source of identity and belonging (Anderson, [1983] 1991) that could transcend nation-states and global geopolitics and envision possible futures through how we remember the past, both in Europe and beyond (Harrison & Sterling, 2020). Central concerns in this debate are the recognition of 'difficult' and 'dissonant' traditions and the contestation of public memory with respect to how an array of themes are represented – colonial traditions and immigration, multiculturalism and transnational history, non-Christian religious heritages in European societies, female heritages, and the inclusion of neglected groups (Connerton 2008, De Nardi et al., 2020; Smith et al., 2020; Häkkilä et al., 2022; Giglitto et al., 2023). Successfully envisioning constructive and socially sustainable futures requires acknowledging the history, identity, belonging, and membership of previously sidelined individuals and groups' (Assmann & Czaplicka, 2015). Questions of eligibility and entitlement are also important in relation to public support, economic outcomes, and ownership claims over memories that are used as cultural heritage resources. But despite extensive work towards participatory and socially inclusive memory work in recent years, the problems and the limitations have not been overcome (Oswald, 2021).

Memories are intrinsically connected to time and space. They encompass both personal and shared experiences, as well as the wider political structures of communities and institutions. Memory work is, therefore, an integral part of life, deeply interlinked not only with individuals' biographical and social trajectories but with the communities they live in (Coraiola et al., 2023). Furthermore, memory work is an important source that can add value to human existence, a value that extends beyond the market sphere (Wadel, 1979; Wallman, 1979). The anthropology of work illuminates the political dimension of memory work and the structural dimensions of adding value to human life through this means. In all four

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spheres of human activity – personal, social, economic, and political – the time and resources available to individuals depend on their social group. Memory work is a considerable investment of work; the time, interest, and priorities that people from different social groups are able or unable, interested or willing to allocate to it therefore also varies (Haug, 2008, 2020). In this context we conceptualise memory work as the intentional processes through which people, groups, and institutions engage in – directly or indirectly – in relations with other actors, identities, and past/present/future memory practices. Research on the practices that constitute participatory memory work (PMW) thus should "take into account not only what is done, how it is done and who does it, but also how and by whom it is evaluated" (Wallman, 1979, p. 1). The politics of participating in the cultural production and reproduction of memories is thus a central dimension of contemporary society. It impacts the contingent memory practices of people, communities, and institutions. Memories therefore connect the smallest scale of human existence with the largest scale of national and global politics (Macdonald, 2013). Memory practices range from present/past memories, traditions, and relations to the shaping of contemporary presents and presents/futures in the making (Bryant & Knight, 2019). They relate to personal and collective practices, identities, and agency, as well as place, materiality, and active acts of imagination, resistance, and contestation (De Nardi et al., 2020; De Nardi, 2022).

A further factor is the continuous expansion of digital media ecologies in the various media technologies and infrastructures. These offer new opportunities, on different scales, for engaging with memory making (Marttila & Botero, 2017; Sheehy et al., 2019). Within the contemporary digital media ecosystems and across the range of memory making modes (Erll, 2009), memory practices can refer to all practices of representing, sharing, and storing information, whether in everyday life or institutional contexts (Barth, 2002). This is irrespective of whether this information will later be referred to as part of personal or public memory making (Olick & Robbins, 1998). Digital infrastructures seem to hold out the promise of opening up novel spaces for exploring new ways to address socially and historically contested heritages and new ways to move towards more inclusive cultural memory practices (Haskins, 2007; Drozdzewski & Birdsall, 2019; Rausch et al., 2022; Giglitto et al., 2023). But contrary perspectives point to the disruptive potential of digital media and the internet, and suggest that digital media platforms and infrastructures are not a productive force for social inclusion and participation (Hoskins, 2018; Abend et al., 2019). Digital media in memory and heritage making can of course offer both positive and negative potentials for digital memory making (Benardou et al., 2014). But this is not technologically determined; it emerges through how they are used and implemented. Future research is needed on the conditions and turning points of these developments.

Since the advent of global digital media, participatory memory practices have undergone a process of transnational and somewhat autonomous evolution, as outlined by Reading (2016). To some extent, these practices are independent of cultural heritage politics and develop in parallel with the governance approaches of political bodies seeking to facilitate their specific national identities.

The proliferation of participatory memory practices has been facilitated by transnational communication, and thus the understanding of what participation means in terms of social inclusion and future making has undergone a similar process of diversification (Rosaldo, 1994; Beaman, 2016). The fluidity of memory practices necessitates the development of new approaches to both the practice of memory and its study. These approaches must acknowledge the situatedness of memory making and the multitude of factors that influence the possibilities, meanings, and outcomes of participation. In this sense, participation is not a mere conceptual term but a subject of study in this book. Consequently, a shift towards participation and inclusion will remain incomplete if only the political and discursive levels of memory work are addressed (Koch, 2013). An effective shift towards participation and inclusion in research on and practice of memory making must consider memory making as fluid and negotiated in specific situations. It must also consider the specific contexts and everyday practices of/in memory institutions and their infrastructures as manifest, but contestable and negotiable, forms of previous ideas and possible future trajectories of memory making. Rather than imposing a single, pre-defined definition of participation, we invited the contributors to engage with their own approaches to participation, which were relevant to the context of their case study. This approach reflects the broad range of definitions and approaches to participation that exist today.

Thus, this book presents a relational research framework for participatory memory practices towards social change: a framework that can bridge and integrate meanings, means, and modes of memory practices to facilitate connectivities between the diverse entities involved in the social processes of memory work[1]. In so doing, the book contributes novel research that is capable of creating shifts for these significant social issues in pluralistic societies towards the organisation of publicly accessible, participatory, and socially inclusive memory practices. Building primarily on examples from Europe, one of the places where participatory memory practices are most vividly explored, while also being intensely entangled in transnational and global connections (Koch & Lutz, 2017; Koch, 2019), this book presents a relational research framework for participatory memory practices towards social change. Consequently, it contributes original approaches that can study and, at the same time, create shifts in participatory memory practices. These approaches are not limited to addressing the significant societal issues that exist in pluralistic societies but extend to the organisation of publicly accessible, participatory, and socially inclusive memory practices elsewhere. This is demonstrated by a case study in Namibia, which brings in dimensions of contested everyday socio-historical spaces and temporalities, to include diverse epistemologies into collaborative future making (Smith et al., 2020). Furthermore, the case invites explorations across transnational contexts, spaces, and situations to show how memory practices are dynamically connected and transformational across local and global sites.

The extent and breadth of the subject matter under consideration spans ten countries, numerous personal and institutional participatory memory practices, memory practices with transnational scope in a variety of media formats, and multiple social

groups not yet presented very well in public memory work, first nation people, children and young people, migrant groups, (post-)colonial voices and homeless people. Nevertheless, in light of the substantial range of participatory memory practices, it is evident that a single volume cannot aim to be exhaustive. Among the many possible extensions of the study of future memory practices in digital media environments, we see particular relevance in the study of community-driven archiving, which is not only widespread among minority groups in the United States but also known elsewhere; transnational practices of decolonial memory making that span the global South and North; and interventionist, action and design-oriented approaches to memory work for sustainable futures.

2 Participatory and inclusive approaches to memory work

The book integrates an exceptionally diverse range of research fields. It brings together, and brings into reflexive dialogue, current research paradigms from the fields of the inclusive museum (Sandell, 2002; Morse, 2020), open repositories and participatory archives (e.g., Van Biljon et al., 2017), digital heritage (e.g., Benardou et al., 2018), critical heritage studies (e.g., Giglitto et al., 2023), design anthropology (e.g., Smith, 2022), social media (e.g., Giaccardi, 2012), media studies (e.g., van Dijck, 2020), and science and technology studies (e.g., Horst et al., 2021). The resulting integration of interdisciplinary, transdisciplinary, and multimodal research on memory making and cultural heritage (Sather-Wagstaff, 2015), provides a rich source for ideas, innovations, and interventions for inclusive, sustainable, and future-envisioning memory practices – for individuals and groups in institutions, and across infrastructures of digital media and technology. This comprehensive perspective on a variety of diverse stakeholders in PMW complements the action-oriented shifts towards inclusive future making. The variety among the actors involved is evident in the networks of NGOs, community projects for education and social inclusion, media production and web publishing, open data consultancies, and in cultural policy. And this diversity and variability emphasises, once again, the need for a relational approach to PMW.

The contributions in this book expand current perspectives on participation by addressing the many changing frameworks in the heritage sector – sociotechnical, organisational, legal, economic, and ethical – that have come into play along with the mediatised memory ecologies in digitalised societies. In a host of rapidly expanding fields where research is increasingly interdisciplinary – in anthropology, archive and library studies, critical heritage studies, digital heritage, museum studies, participatory design, sociology, science and technology studies, and sustainability studies – the meaning of participation has become a central topic of debate (Abend et al., 2019; Baetens et al., 2020; Douglas-Jones et al., 2021; Smith et al., 2024). Rather than assuming the benefits of participation for its own sake, the focus of research is shifting to the challenges and limitations, as well as the ideological and practical factors (Boersma et al., 2020; Boersma, 2022; Edenheiser et al., 2020; Zwart, 2024), that influence the ideas and practices of participation in context. The research presented in this book therefore both scrutinises participation

and evaluates it. This calls for a new theoretical framework, sometimes discussed as post-participation (Van Mensch & Meijer-Van Mensch, 2022) and conscious evaluation of power dynamics and social structure. Each chapter provides suggestions to take these essential debates beyond mere participation.

This book therefore introduces a new perspective to the study of participation. On the conceptual level, it pays attention to the modalities in which participatory approaches in memory making enfold their positive or problematic potential. The concept 'memory modalities' (Koch et al., 2021) integrates the socio-material conditions of memory research and provides a heuristic for studying these modalities as one of the crucial elements in participatory and socially inclusive approaches to memory and heritage making. Despite the extensive research on the role of media in memory formation (Erll, 2009, 2020; Hajek et al., 2015; Hoskins, 2018), a systematic problematisation of the socio-material aspect has not been achieved in either memory research or digital cultural heritage. The concept of memory modalities serves to bridge this gap in a meaningful manner, expanding the socio-material dimensions of memory construction beyond the media employed to encompass the broader context of personal, institutional, and civil society memory formation (Koch et al., 2021).

The shift towards digital technologies has brought these issues to our attention, but it should not be the sole approach for examining memory modalities. Memory making exists as a complex bundle of practices, situated within various contexts that encompass and assemble diverse materials and social and organisational forms; it navigates legal, economic, and technological structures and social norms (van Dijck, 2020; Hayden, 2021; Hjorth, 2021; Horst et al., 2021). The experience of this gap in research is widely recognised among practitioners in professional memory making who have experienced the inertia of the existing organisational, infrastructural, legal, and economic conditions, an inertia that frequently hinders approaches to participation and inclusion. Both institutional and individual intentions with regard to participation and inclusion continue to depend on memory modalities that assist them by opening up institutional and public memory making to a broad spectrum of people and groups in civil society on all levels – local, translocal, national, and transnational. Focusing on memory modalities enables practitioners and researchers to examine the mediatised character of memory and heritage making (or to theorise how the mediality affects memory practices) without losing sight of further memory modalities in which digital media and infrastructures are used. The particular relevance of memory modalities in the representation, circulation, and sustaining of cultural knowledge in digital media needs to be complemented through social framings.

Furthermore, the concept of memory modalities allows us to connect to the emerging discussions on memory ecologies and heritage ecologies and thus broaden perspectives from different angles. The concept of memory modalities provides a lens with which to examine the agency of the socio-material in these ecologies as a relevant factor (Harrison, 2015; Zirra, 2017; Rigney, 2017) with its own stake in the 'worlding' of heritage (Fredengren, 2021). It allows us to study the socio-material dimensions as a unique and significant involvement in memory

ecologies. Whether regarding memory ecologies as emergent and predisposed *interactional trajectories of experience* (Schacter & Welker, 2016; Hoskins, 2016), or in relation to worldviews as *cognitive ecologies* (Heersmink, 2020), the concept of memory modalities brings a new lens to the study and care of memory ecologies and memory work as well as to their participatory and inclusive transformation. It furthermore contributes to decentring the human and calls attention to the material conditions of memory work and its transformation.

In providing a novel framework for transformative research in memory and heritage studies, this book presents design anthropology as a unique strand in the exploration of participation in the field of memory making and cultural heritage. This approach engages actively with participation through experimentation and interventions in digitalisation; in so doing, it works towards the decolonisation of heritage institutions and in everyday life (Smith, 2022). Participatory design, with its long-standing tradition of inclusive and creative research approaches, lends opportunities that can empower local communities and institutions through collaborative engagements in prototyping with digital technologies and cultural materials (Bødker et al., 2022). Here, the researchers involve professionals and diverse communities in dialogic processes of curation with the aim of exploring and co-designing novel cultural (material, historical, and digital) representations (Smith & Otto, 2016; Koch, 2021; Otto, Deger & Marcus, 2021). This work extends the idea of participation towards transdisciplinary approaches and contexts – from the collaborative design of exhibitions and community archiving to participatory prototyping of interactive installations, to future memory making and co-designing with marginalised groups and indigenous communities, and beyond (Onciul, 2017). Moreover, as a transformative and decolonial force in memory making, design anthropology opens the way towards decolonial and pluriversal futures that can engage multiple worlds and epistemologies (Escobar, 2018, Stuedahl et al., 2021; Smith et al., 2024; Winschiers-Theophilus et al., 2024). It can bring further emphasis to the temporalities of pasts/presents/futures (Kambunga et al., 2023) and to the multimodality of memory work and the making of worlds.

3 A relational approach to future memory work

A central motivation for the contributions presented in this book is an emphasis on connections and connectivity. This is an emerging topic in memory research, as evidenced by the already-mentioned emergent discussions on memory ecologies (Schacter & Weller, 2016; Hoskins, 2016) and heritage ecologies (Bangstad & Rinke, 2021). The book and its contributions provide a novel framework for PMW and thus give direction to the future of memory work. For the first time, the relational research approach of PMW is applied as a lens to delineate and explore how institutions, people and groups, and memory modalities negotiate the building of connectivities and their versions of participatory and socially inclusive memory work. The POEM initiative further developed this notion of PMW founded on the principle of relationality, taking into consideration the social, cultural, legal,

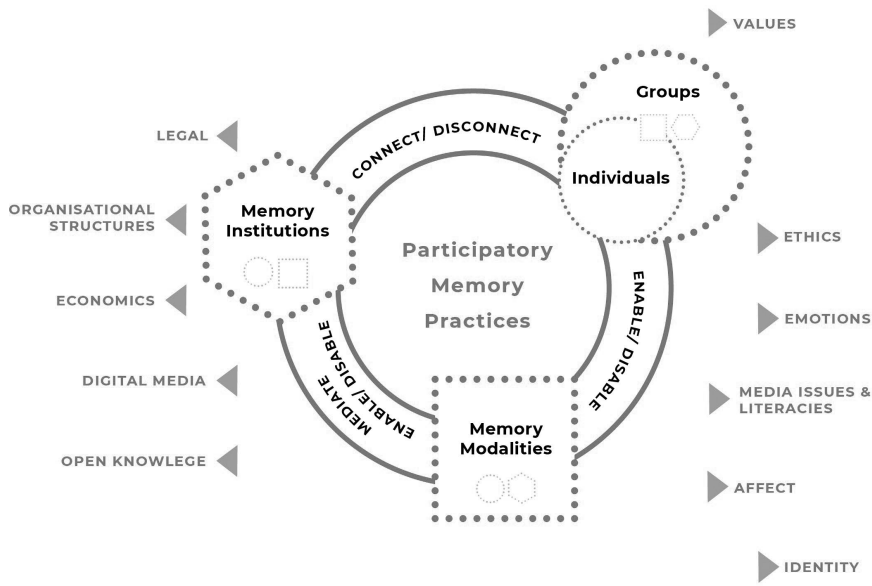


Figure 1.1 Model of Participatory Memory Work.

economic, and material factors involved in memory creation and emphasising the processes and fluidity of participatory memory making. This was done by integrating multiple actors across research and practice in interdisciplinary and empirical research projects that contributed to developing the Model of Participatory Memory Work (Figure. 1.1. above). Relationality in this book refers to the discussion of transformative ontologies in science that seek new grounds to go beyond modern thought. In the tradition of decentring the human, and with the contemporary emphasis on the Anthropocene in the face of current societal crisis, relationality invites us to explore new figures of thought, new material practices, and new politics as transformative possibilities for (re-)making the world through building intersections between knowledge domains and ways of knowing (Escobar et al., 2024).

The Model of Participatory Memory Work (see Figure 1.1) provides a heuristic for the exploration of contextual factors that affect the creation of memories, taking into account individuals and their groups, memory institutions, and the memory modalities as key actors of memory work. As a conceptual framework, the centre of the model focuses on participatory memory practices, and two additional layers are introduced that are specifically related to this core. The next layer consists of the three main zones of agency in PMW: individuals and groups, institutions, and memory modalities. This is followed by a layer of basic concepts that are interwoven with participatory memory practices. In the model these are visualised as triangles: they include ethics, emotions, media issues and literacy, affect, identity, legal and economic frameworks, organisational structures, digital media, and open knowledge.

The model highlights the relationality that enfolds between the diverse components in and across these layers in several modes. The *zones of agency*, encompassing individuals and groups, institutions, and memory modalities, intersect with each other while maintaining their distinct characteristics. The model illustrates this by incorporating the shapes of each zone of agency with permeable lines into every other zone of agency. Secondly, practices are constitutive for memory work through (dis-)connecting, enabling/disabling, and mediating memories, which can either facilitate or hinder participation. These practices are key components for the agency of PMW and circulate between the three zones, with varying relevance and impact on participation. The practices that are crucial for the agency of PMW are situated in specific contexts and are related to the global assemblage of PMW. They have the capacity to either limit or facilitate social inclusion and to envision options for participatory futures. The basic concepts are intensely coupled and more or less relevant in specific social contexts or the research approaches taken to study them.

The three zones of agency are shaped through specific modes of memory. *Memory institutions* such as museums, archives, and libraries are organisational structures that are constantly evolving. As initiators and facilitators of participatory processes, they play a central role in navigating public stakes and motivations, and in defining what is considered to be memory and heritage. They have an official responsibility for PMW and can provide a platform for actors, issues, and discourses. *Individuals and groups* form communities of practice for memory making through personal, often intimate, everyday practices – even if these practices are rarely reflected upon as memory making. Everyday memory practices form the basis for inclusion in public memory, acknowledging the history, identity, belonging, and membership of individuals and groups. This zone is central for participating in economic, social, and political outcomes and representations of society, as well as for ownership of resources emerging from cultural heritage and envisioning possible futures. *Memory modalities* are assemblages that emerge through specific components or socio-material arrangements of open-ended entanglements of intangible components that enable memory practices. They form around socio-material elements such as digital infrastructures, licensing types, ethical codes, algorithms, legal frameworks, economic models, and memory institutions. They co-configure memory work as current and future activity.

As a relational concept, PMW involves three constitutive practices: connecting and disconnecting, enabling and disabling, and mediating between the three zones of agency, individuals and groups, institutions, and memory modalities. These practices do not inherently facilitate or hinder participatory memory practices, but their quality is situational and results from constant negotiation, reflection, and reinvention. Practices take on various forms and are best understood as bundles of actions. For instance, establishing a connection with a migrant group requires a series of small actions using various approaches that are likely to differ across specific contexts. Individual practices of documenting and sharing memories are based on media, but only partially align with the modes of communication provided by digital media infrastructures such as the internet, or with archival practices in institutional memory work. Still, the connecting nature of these practices

has the potential to bridge to other realms and circulate through all three zones of agency in PMW. What actually stabilises or destabilises connections in memory work is an open process: the sources of facilitating or hindering connectivities between groups of migrants or young people or other social groups and museums or archives or the available digital and mobile media are manifold. Communication between institutions and groups can (though it must not) fail for many reasons – misunderstandings or technical errors, a lack of common sense, obscure language, divergent uses of media, and more. Furthermore, organising participation in memory work requires reconfiguring power relations among actors. This transformation involves enabling new groups – migrants, indigenous communities, people from the Global South, and children – who previously lacked the potential to bring their voices to public attention in memory work. At the same time, it involves reducing the prominence of powerful and established speakers in memory institutions or politics. Enabling and disabling practices refer to a wide range of transformations necessary to achieve inclusion and create new forms that facilitate and promote it. Enabling can refer to personal growth and capacity building, transforming memories and identities, to exploring, designing, providing, and institutionalising spaces for envisioning, learning, and experimenting with memory work. Additionally, mediation is a central practice that extends beyond media infrastructures. It includes all activities as an intermediary between the components of PMW – facilitating relationships, communication, translation, and other forms of connecting various elements. This can be achieved through techniques such as interweaving these components through narrations, finding boundary objects for joint activities, or exploring pathways to empathy and stewardship for others.

The Model of Participatory Memory Work enhances research on PMW by introducing a systematic and heuristic framework for identifying and exploring the interactional connections, power dynamics, and hierarchical structures within memory formation. The relational approach to memory practices integrates those dimensions that are relevant to the situatedness of memory making; these further dimensions enhance the initial model, which was used to guide the empirical research undertaken in the POEM project, with further concepts that are inherently entangled with memory practices. Moreover, the perspective shifts from an actor-centred model to a practices-centred model, grounded in the findings of the projects' empirical research. By extending beyond structural dimensions and encompassing frequently unacknowledged components with significance for memory practices, such as values, ethics, emotions, affect, and identities, the Model of Participatory Memory Work allows us to grasp the mechanisms of inclusion and acknowledgement.

The Model of Participatory Memory Work thus facilitates situational analyses by offering a clear and concise approach to problematisation and research. The project's emphasis on under-represented groups and their approaches to memory formation highlights the fact that the power imbalances observed in participatory approaches by institutional actors often stem from colonial traditions that unconsciously perpetuate disadvantage among these same groups, both within Europe and beyond (Smith et al., 2020; 2024).

This relational approach was used to develop a novel understanding of the formation of memories and the conditions under which they come into being. It was applied to investigate diverse contexts, situations, and social groups, as well as their use of media in memory construction practices. Drawing on 13 research projects and diverse research approaches – action research, collaborative ethnography, mixed methods, ethnography of infrastructure, and design anthropology – our project's exploration of relationality could take different directions and advance the knowledge about relevant factors and elements in PMW. The breadth of the work – the multiplicity of approaches, the interdisciplinariness of the research group, the variety of different sites in and across Europe and beyond, the transnational connections and practices of memory work, and the transdisciplinary interaction with various actors in the field from the beginning of the project – contributed to the production of what is called 'robust knowledge' because it is relevant across social domains and contexts (Nowotny, 2003; Weingart, 2008). However, the relational approach does show a clear bias in the emphasis it places on inclusive and empowering practices for often marginalised groups such as refugees, migrants, colonial communities, disadvantaged young people, and gender issues. This emphasis contributes to developing a socially inclusive public memory for future possibilities.

4 Transdisciplinary evaluation agendas for future memory work

Reimagining participation in memory work also requires new methods of assessing participatory activities (Economou et al., 2019). Assessment approaches need to have the capacity to adequately evaluate novel approaches to participation as relational activities of people, institutions, and memory modalities, and to evaluate their applicability in different memory making contexts with their specific digital media settings. Such an assessment must go beyond the conventional methods of averaging click rates and monitoring user behaviour (Clough et al., 2017). A broader understanding is needed of the implications of methods currently employed to incorporate the individuals and communities who have yet to appear in memory making. Social impact measurement and evaluation have developed advanced methodologies for numerous fields, but not for the cultural sector. The research presented in this book contributes to work by young researchers in social impact measurement who have investigated the implementation and effectiveness of these strategies. They draw attention to the intricacies and temporal aspects integral to culture change that impact significantly both on culture itself and on its evaluation. Moreover, the move from theory to practice, from theoretical reflection to implementation of new modes of participation in memory making in and beyond the memory institutions, finds support in the POEM Toolbox, which provides practical entry points for change and reflection in participatory approaches in digital media environments. Translating theoretical insights and reflections into practical approaches that are applicable in and across several cultural fields thus advances a transdisciplinary agenda for evaluating memory work. These novel methodological approaches and practices need to be an integral part of advancing a coherent future research trajectory for future memory work.

5 Relational memory work of institutions, people, and modalities

The relational research approaches presented in this book all share the assumption that memory practices related to institutions, people, and groups, and memory modalities constantly negotiate the connectivities in memory work. This helping or hindering affects the possibilities for, and the ideas of, participation that may be put into place or emerge in the future. Learning from successful examples, as well as from mismatches, conflicts, and obstacles in these processes of PMW, provides the opportunity for reflection on how to bridge these gaps. This approach emphasises inclusive and empowering practices for groups on the margins – refugees, migrants, colonial groups, and disadvantaged young people under consideration of gender questions. It can contribute to a new understanding of how a socially inclusive public memory for future possibilities emerges through theory and practice. The research approaches advanced in this book have transformative potential, both in empirical research and in collaborative engagement with the subjects from various perspectives, sites, and approaches – mixed methods, action research, collaborative ethnography, ethnography of infrastructure, design anthropology, and co-design methods. Integrating diverse approaches and multiple sites across Europe and beyond has enabled the production of knowledge that is applicable across social contexts and future-oriented domains (Nowotny, 2003; Weingart, 2008).

In the first three of the four main sections, of *Memory Institutions*, *People and Groups*, and *Memory Modalities*, the book presents connectivity-building memory practices from the relational perspectives of stakeholders in PMW and their specific zones of agency. Each section integrates complementary perspectives from the single research projects on the agencies in PMW for a joint knowledge production in and across the sections and makes it available for exchanges across research contexts and stakeholders. Owing to the principles of complementarity that were built into the overall concept of the POEM project, knowledge production in each section contributes to representing and contrasting groups, nations, genders, social situations, media formats, and infrastructures. The book thereby provides insights and knowledge across a wide range of interconnected themes and concerns, taking full account of the complex conditions of memory making that emerge from situatedness in various contexts of social and cultural life with a differing spectrum of legal, economic, and ethical affairs.

A fourth main section, *Future Memory Work* is dedicated to the transdisciplinary character and outcomes derived from the POEM research. It displays the interweaving of memory research and memory work in a joint knowledge production of tools and approaches that contribute to the robustness of the knowledge, a joint knowledge production that would not have emerged otherwise. Furthermore, it highlights the exploratory, experimental character of PMW and the complementary character of both theoretical and practical knowledge production. These transdisciplinary approaches call for new formats that can bridge between the sectors and their specific modes of knowing.

5.1 Memory institutions: shifting professional memory practices

Despite all the efforts of the memory institutions, participation is still a difficult topic for them. The chapters in section one provide deeper insights and theoretical reflection on the connectivities built by institutions. They produce knowledge about the variety of participatory approaches that consider the new mediated memory modalities or build them up newly, such as the reuse of digital heritage, or social media communication with audiences. Studying how PMW affects professional memory work at its core and in its organisational structure, as well as expectations about audiences and their role in memory work, can make visible the structures to which people and groups from culturally and gender-diverse backgrounds can connect.

Chapter 2, *Shifting from 'inside-out' to 'outside in': Envisioning ways of structurally integrating participatory principles in museums*, reflects on participation as a fundamental aspect of museum work. While many of the principles of participation remain underexplored or even entirely absent within the internal organisation, it is important to acknowledge and address them. This chapter examines the revised understanding of participation, which requires museums to be accessible, inclusive, and open to the public and also working with communities in an ethical and professional manner. The chapter outlines four principles defining participatory museum practices, and explains how these principles can be integrated into the institution's operations. The authors explore what museums would look like and how they would operate if participatory principles were integrated into their internal organisation to achieve the museum envisioned in the ICOM definition. They suggest that these internal changes are necessary for an institution that is de-centred in relation to its public, committed to continuous learning, and caring for people, their objects, and their stories.

Chapter 3, *Situating participation in the backstage: Infrastructural settings impacting museum work* addresses the challenges faced by staff members at three memory institutions – the Swedish National Historical Museums in Stockholm, the National Museums in Berlin, and the Hunterian Art Gallery in Glasgow – in aligning their work routines and practices with the imperatives of participatory missions. The author highlights the dynamics that unfold as employees navigate the intersection of their routine tasks with the overarching vision of inclusive memory making advocated by their respective institutions in the interplays of the technical and informational aspects of museum operations. Narratives and behind-the-scenes decisions are scrutinised. The chapter suggests a method for assessing the feasibility of evaluating an institution's dedication to a participatory approach while taking into account the dominant actors and established sociotechnical arrangements within the evolving GLAM institution.

Chapter 4, *Ethical practices in participatory memory work: Examples from the Museum Europäischer Kulturen in Berlin*, problematises the relevance of codes of ethics in participatory museum work. The chapter presents a foundation for addressing the necessary work related to these aspects and suggests a participatory method for establishing ethical considerations in a project. In practice, rather than delving into ethical theory, the study of ethics is based on practical examples of

various participatory projects. From participation as a means of achieving truthful representation to consent forms as an integral part of the practice of care, this chapter highlights the various tools and procedures that ensure ethical practices in museums. The examples also point to processes of learning. The chapter concludes with a professional approach to ethics. This translates into practitioners recognising their own positions, while also setting aside the time and space to construct and reflect on ethical practices with the participants. Participatory projects require a participatory process in which staff and participants collaborate to develop ethical guidelines and discuss questions and necessary measures.

5.2 People and groups: digital memory making at the margins

Everyone engages in manifold memory making practices as a part of everyday life. Still, not all individuals and groups connect well to public memory work. The chapters in this section provide deeper insights into and theoretical reflection on PMW and the connectivities built by people and groups. They draw on empirical research into personal and public memory practices of people and groups on social media platforms, and their engagement with cultural materials from memory institutions. They produce knowledge about motivations for people and for groups, ideas for the use and reuse of cultural materials, and empowering strategies for young people in marginalised populations harnessing the power of imagination of possible futures through PMW.

Pluriversal futures: Design anthropology for contested memory making at the margins, Chapter 5, presents a decolonial perspective on participation and contributes a design anthropological approach to PMW. The authors promote memory work as a means of envisioning and negotiating pluriversal futures, using digital and mediated spaces for participating in memory work. The approach integrates diverse interdisciplinary research methods, interventions, and technologies to facilitate the emergence of multiple perspectives, memories, and voices. In cases from Denmark, Namibia, and Greenland, under-represented voices are amplified, and dialogue is fostered on contentious issues. With a focus on contested everyday spaces, the framework suggests engagement through three socio-spatial forms: *reflective safe spaces, creative third spaces*, and *dialogic public spaces*. The chapter contributes a design anthropological framework for PMW in contested contexts to advance inclusive memory futures towards pluriversality.

Chapter 6, *Conducting bereavement interviews: Methodological reflections on talking about death, grief, and memory,* addresses the increasing relevance of social media sites as digital spaces for individual memory practices. Social media sites are an increasingly important platform for individuals to engage in memory practices as a digital legacy after death, and, accordingly, as a space for bereavement. From a methodological approach, the chapter presents a study of individual memory practices after the loss of beloved relatives or friends. These are aspects of memory work that are difficult to study due to ethical and sensitivity concerns. The authors offer guidelines for researchers on how to conduct interviews with individuals who are grieving, and how to support research and practitioners in bereavement studies more broadly.

5.3 Memory modalities: socio-material assemblages of memory formation

The emerging digital media ecologies held out the promise of a broader inclusion of people and groups in public memory work, but these positive visions do not correspond with actual developments. The chapters in this section provide deeper insights into the connectivities built by memory modalities. The research produces knowledge about the participation-enabling qualities that institutions, as well as people and groups, perceive in their engagement with the current mediatised memory ecology. The chapters provide novel perspectives on the ways in which participation is encouraged or hindered by the specific nature of the regimes within which the professional institutions must operate. These include not only the digital infrastructures for collecting, archiving, displaying, and retrieving information but also the internet platforms for individual or collective memory practices and for sharing cultural materials, as well as the legal frameworks for copyrights and open access, the gendered cultural economy of the digital, and the ethical considerations and codes of conducts guiding public memory work.

Chapter 7, *Memory modalities: Explorations into socio-material arrangements of the past at the present for the future*, introduces and explores memory modalities as a conceptual approach with which to study the arrangements in which memories are made, represented, and mediated. The term 'arrangement' implies that the complexity and diversity of memory modalities, as with any set of memory practices, cannot be reduced to simple antitheses between human and nonhuman, social and technical, cultural and natural features. This chapter proposes ecological thinking that pays attention to neglected entities, invisible work, and hidden layers, both human and nonhuman. Memory modalities operate independently of genres, forms, and media. They direct attention towards action, existence, and transformation rather than mediation or material objects; and they point to participation being a never-ending mission in memory work.

Chapter 8, *Memory loss: Youth and the fragility of personal digital remembering*, focuses on the creation and sharing of personal memories on social media sites or messenger services with digital media as a mundane everyday activity for young people across the globe. Smartphones are ubiquitous and are frequently used for memory practices by young people. This results in ever-growing personal memory archives that often encompass tens of thousands of digital memory objects. This contribution challenges the proposition that the internet never forgets. This investigation of the memory modalities of personal memory making highlights the invisible maintenance work of digital memory objects needed to ensure continuous access. These memory practices are interdependent with the available digital infrastructures and devices to access them. Both of these need to be managed.

5.4 Future memory work: toolbox and approaches

There is a general lack of practical tools and practices for concrete engagement with PMW across institutions, people, and modalities. The final section reflects on and presents exemplary practices and tools for future memory work for researchers,

institutions, and communities. All the tools and approaches presented in this section can be accessed from the POEM website and can be directly applied in diverse heritage and memory settings.[2]

Chapter 9, *Towards a relational approach to social impact measurement of Participatory Memory Practices: new concepts for future memory work,* discusses social impact evaluation and the measurement of cultural work as a new memory modality for memory practices – specifically in institutional memory making, but with relevance also for individual memory work. Emphasising the limits of neoliberal modes of assessment, in particular for the cultural sector, the chapter contributes a theory-driven model for evaluating and assessing the impact that addresses the need for benchmarks or baselines that can measure change and the regrettable reality that timescales are insufficient to realise outcomes. This chapter develops a conceptual approach to impact measurement, learning both from research in nonprofit management and from research on social change in cultural anthropology. The relational concept presented is grounded in the heuristics of the Model of Participatory Memory Work in support of the development of relational approaches in the field.

Providing a toolbox chapter is something that scientific books rarely do. This, however, is the contribution of the final Chapter 10, *Towards a toolbox for future envisioning memory practices*. Based on the various research engagements in POEM, the chapter presents novel tools for use in PMW in both digital and non-digital media environments. It critically examines how these tools can contribute to changing memory work by strengthening social inclusiveness and by facilitating reflexivity and the future-envisioning potentials of memory practices. The tools presented demonstrate the interdependence of tools and practices for empowering individuals and promoting agency. They are crucial for PMW research – for process and outcomes, for validation, and for ongoing discussions about potential futures.

Conclusion: future memory work

Participatory approaches to everyday memory and institutional forms of cultural heritage presented in this book, produce new opportunities for engagement in an increasingly digital society. Opening opportunities for reframing and designing alternative futures with groups and communities, these approaches also advance novel future-oriented perspectives. The challenge ahead is to find ways of scaling these approaches across contexts, scapes, flows, and spaces – to explore the wider transformative and participatory potentials of inclusive memory practices as forms of global assemblages. The research contributes to the formation of socio-material arrangements that resonate with the multiplicity and diversity of the social, political, and economic settings of memory practices. These open to multidisciplinary approaches that support the development of policies for inclusive and socially sustainable futures.

The paradigmatic nature of relational memory work builds on the explorative, processual, and experimental character of memory practices. The Epilogue draws together the relational approach to PMW presented in the book and, together, the contributions provide solid research trajectories for future memory work.

Notes

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2 www.poem-horizon.eu/impact

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